UI/UX DESIGN

BeReal Passport & Community Boards — UI/UX Design

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> *Independent concept created for a UI/UX Design & Product Management Externship. Not affiliated with or endorsed by BeReal.*

Summary

I designed every screen of BeReal Passport & Community Boards in **Canva** as a high-fidelity, slide-by-slide prototype: seven screens, four UI states and three re-engagement hooks, each annotated with what the user does and why. The Canva deck then became the spec for the clickable HTML prototype.

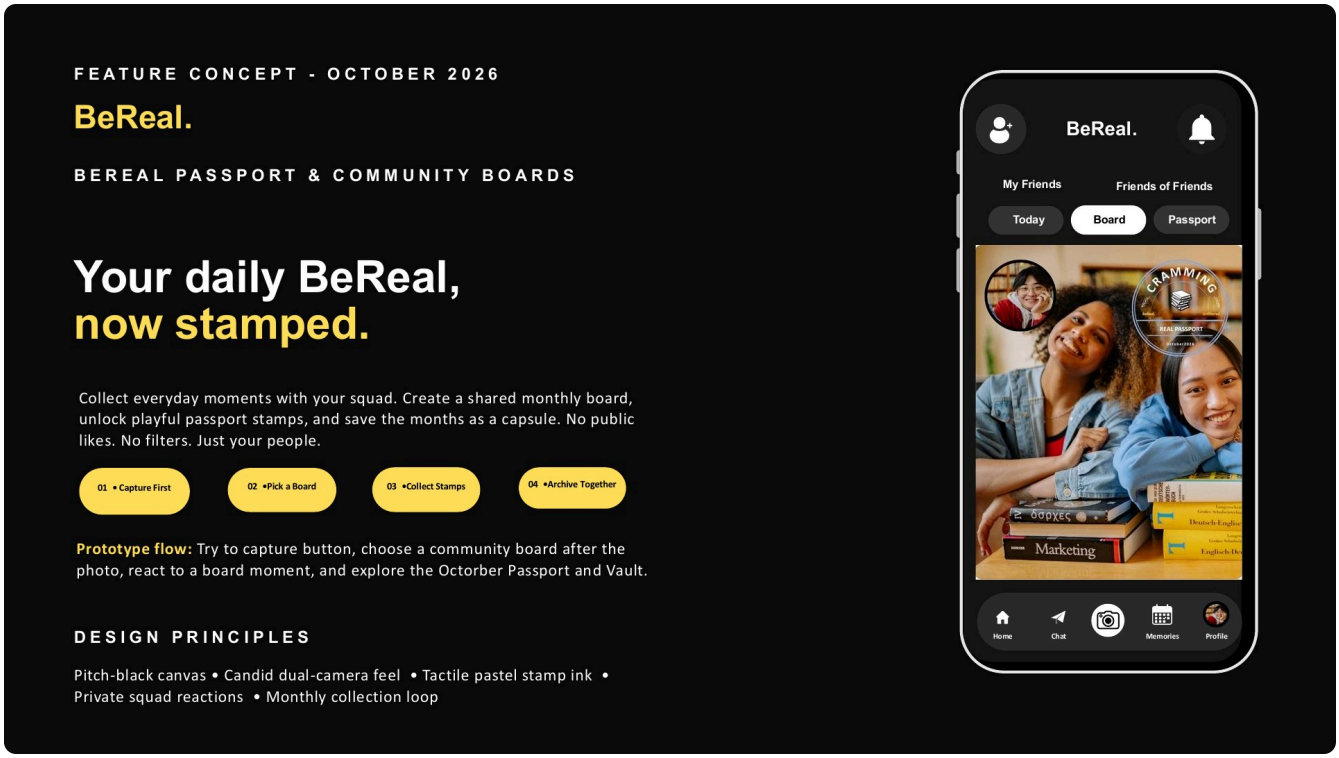
The design goal in one line: **add a new reason to open BeReal without making it feel like a different app.** Every new element had to look and behave like it already belonged in BeReal.

Design principles

I set five visual principles and a four-step flow before designing any screen, and wrote them on the concept slide so every later decision could be checked against them.

Principle	What it means on screen
Pitch-black canvas	BeReal's near-black background everywhere; color is reserved for stamps and a single call to action
Candid dual-camera feel	The familiar back camera full frame, with the front camera as a small overlay; no filters, no retakes
Tactile pastel stamp ink	Each board gets a passport stamp with its own muted ink color, like a real travel stamp
Private squad reactions	Reactions stay inside the squad; there are no public like counts anywhere
Monthly collection loop	Boards close each month and become a capsule, a keepsake rather than an endless feed

The flow: 01 Capture First → 02 Pick a Board → 03 Collect Stamps → 04 Archive Together



UX principles behind the decisions

Principle	Where it shows up
Jakob's law (users expect your app to work like the ones they know)	Top bar, Friends tabs and bottom navigation are kept exactly as in BeReal; the feature lives *inside* familiar patterns
Hick's law (fewer choices, faster decisions)	After the photo there are only two choices: **SEND** or **COMMUNITY BOARD**
Visibility of system status	Every post shows loading, success or error, plus an empty state
Feedback	Picking a board turns its card from grey to white and its lock icon to unlocked
Recognition over recall	Each board shows its stamp, name, lock state and post count, so nothing has to be remembered
Progressive disclosure	A one-time intro for new users; returning users go straight to the board snapshot
Error prevention	Boards are opt-in only; nobody is auto-enrolled
Gestalt grouping	Boards sit in a uniform 3-column card grid; related settings sit together under Features
Emotional design	Copy invites rather than pressures: "No one's posted to this board yet — be the first!"

Design system

Token	Value	Used for
Canvas	`#0A0A0A` (near-black)	Every screen background
Surface	`#2C2C2C` (dark grey)	Cards, rows, unselected board tiles and pills
Text	`#FFFFFF`	Wordmark, headings and labels
Muted text	Grey	Helper copy, timestamps, "Friends of Friends"
Accent	`#FFDE59` (yellow)	One call to action per screen (e.g. "View October Capsule Carousel") and the slide annotations
Selected state	`#FFFFFF` fill, black text	Active tab ("Today", "Board", "Passport") and the chosen board
Stamp inks	Cramming `#99AACB` · Hike `#16A463` · Coffee `#C39879` · Haunted `#B8672B` · Game Time `#EDD869` · Little Wins `#99A9C9`	One ink color per board

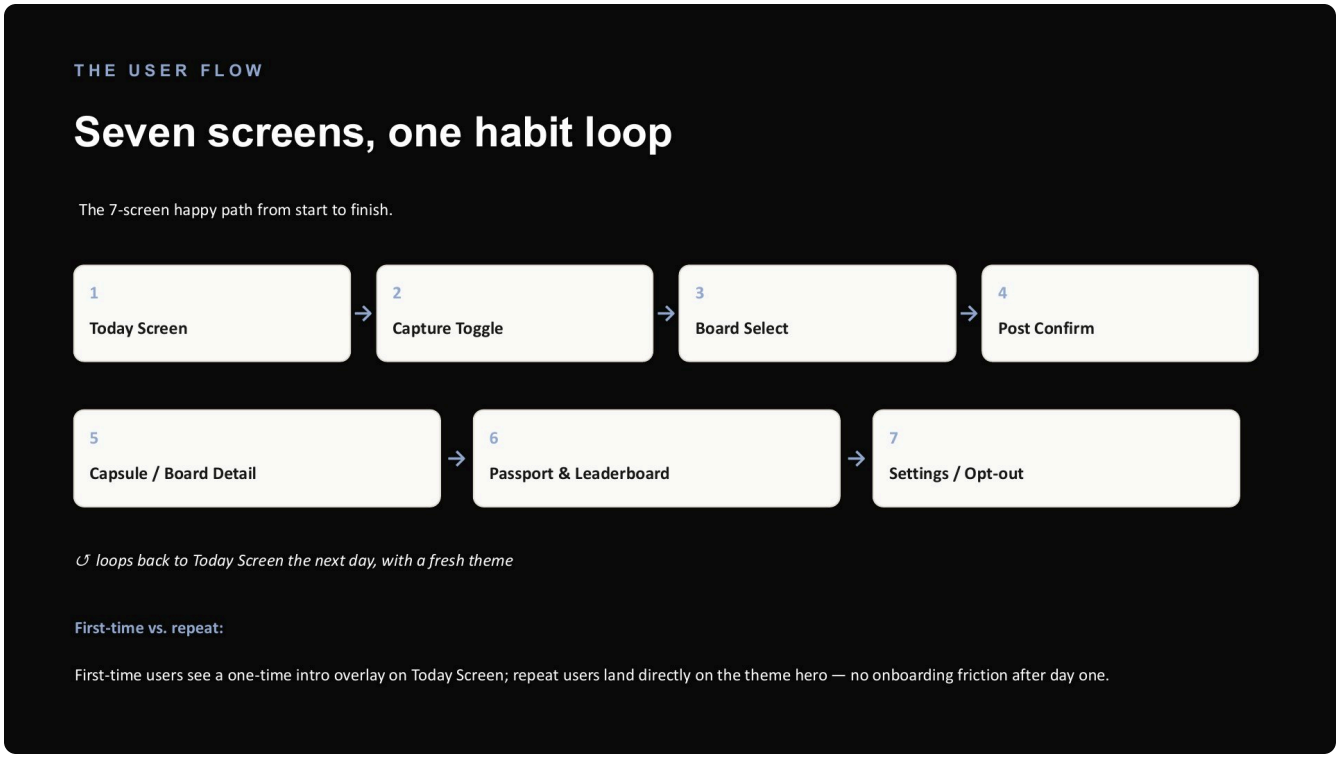
Typography: a bold sans serif for the "BeReal." wordmark, screen titles and buttons; a regular sans serif for helper text, kept small and grey so it never competes with the photo. The slide annotations use wide letter-spacing in all caps ("FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026").

Shapes: rounded rectangles for phones, cards and rows; fully rounded pills for tabs and buttons; circles for the shutter, avatars and stamps.

Accessibility check: white on the canvas is a 19.8 : 1 contrast ratio, yellow on the canvas 14.9 : 1, and white on the grey surface 14.0 : 1. All of these pass WCAG AA and AAA for normal text. Color is never the only signal: a selected board also changes its label and lock icon.

Building the prototype in Canva

Each screen was built as a phone mockup on a dark slide: a rounded-rectangle device frame, the screen content layered inside, and annotations on the left explaining the user's action and the reasoning. Arrows connect each "before" screen to its "after" screen, so a reviewer can follow the flow without clicking.



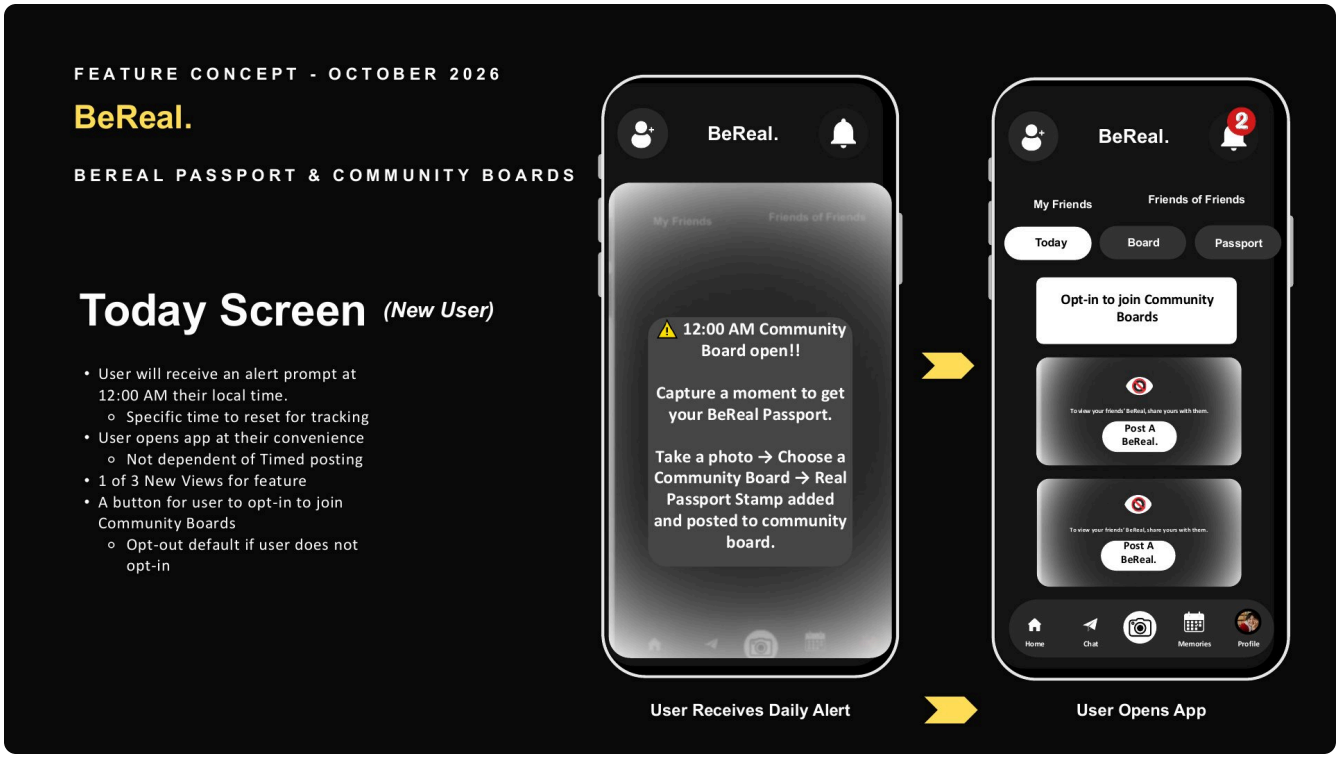
Reusable building blocks, duplicated across every screen so they stay identical:

Component	Built from	Why it's reusable
Top bar	Add-friend icon · "BeReal." wordmark · bell icon with a red count badge	Anchors every screen as BeReal
Friends tabs	Two text labels: "My Friends" · "Friends of Friends"	Mirrors BeReal's existing feed switcher
Feature tabs	Three pills: **Today · Board · Passport**, with the active one filled white	The single entry point to the whole feature
Bottom navigation	Home · Chat · camera shutter (circle) · Memories · Profile	Unchanged from BeReal, so the feature never feels separate
Board tile	Grey rounded card · stamp image · lock icon · friend avatars · post count	One tile works for the grid, select and snapshot screens
Passport stamp	Circular badge: board name in curved text, an illustration, "REAL PASSPORT", "BeReal." and "Unfiltered" labels, the month	The collectible at the heart of the feature
Pop-up modal	Grey rounded card over a blurred screen, with an icon and a message	Used for the intro, loading, success, error and reminders

Screen by screen

1. Today screen (new user)

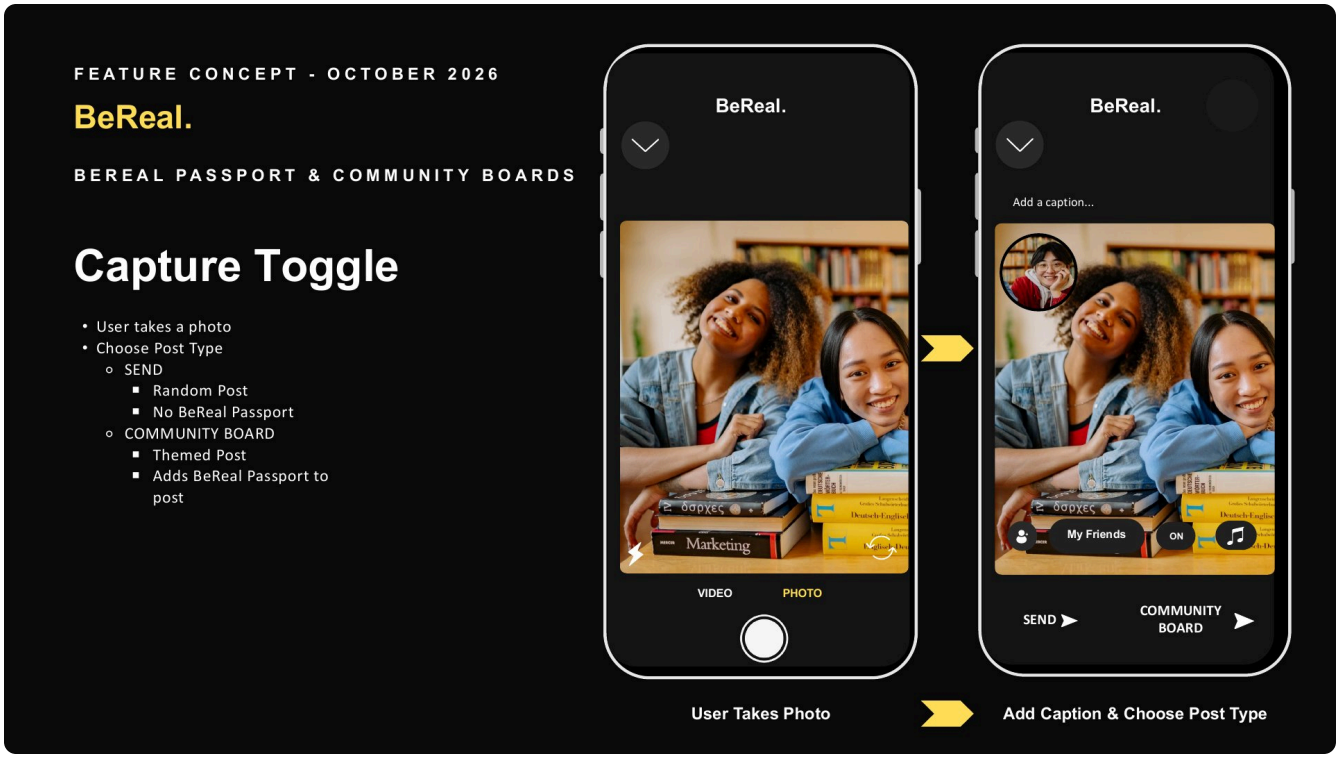
Goal: tell users the month's boards are open and invite them to join, without pressure.



Element	Design decision
12:00 AM alert	A pop-up in BeReal's familiar warning style: "⚠️ 12:00 AM Community Board open!!" It's a fixed daily reset, not a timed post, so users open the app whenever it suits them.
How-it-works line	"Take a photo → Choose a Community Board → Real Passport Stamp added", the whole feature in one sentence
Opt-in button	A white card at the top of the feed: "Opt-in to join Community Boards." It's the only bright element, so it's the obvious next step
Locked feed	Friends' posts stay blurred, with an eye-off icon and "To view your friends' BeReal, share yours with them," reusing BeReal's own reciprocity rule and copy

2. Capture toggle

Goal: keep capture exactly as fast as today, then offer the board as a choice.

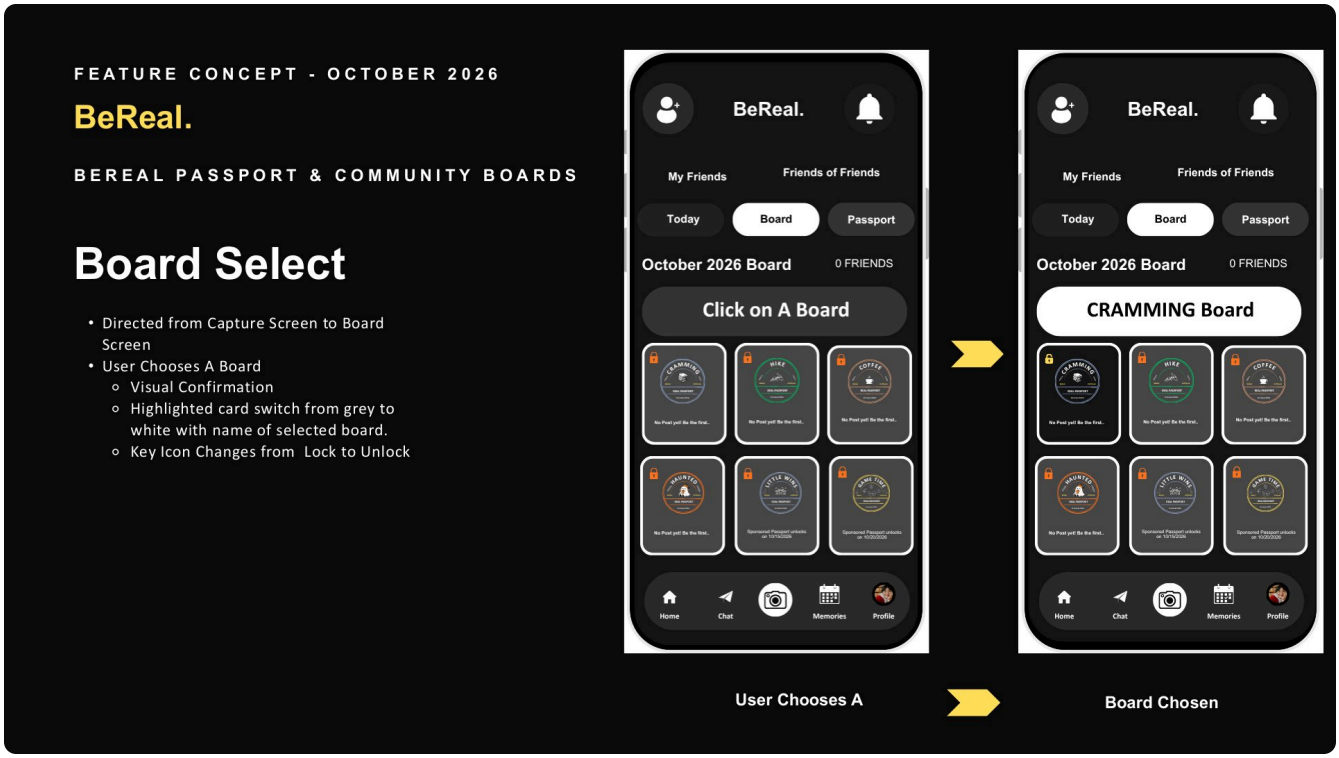


Element	Design decision
Camera screen	Unchanged: back camera full frame, front camera overlay at top left, VIDEO / PHOTO labels and the circular shutter
Post-type choice	Two buttons at the bottom: **SEND** (random post, no stamp) and **COMMUNITY BOARD** (themed post that adds a stamp). Two options only (Hick's law)
Community Board toggle	A small "ON" switch next to "My Friends" shows which audience the post goes to
Caption field	"Add a caption..." stays at the top, as in BeReal

Key decision: the board choice comes *after* the photo. Testers later noticed this adds a step, which became the top fix in the Test Plan.

3. Board select

Goal: make choosing a board feel instant and unmistakable.



Element	Design decision
Header	"October 2026 Board" with a friend count, so users know which month they're in
Prompt bar	"Click on a Board" changes to the board's name ("CRAMMING Board") once chosen
Board grid	Six tiles in a 3 × 2 grid: four themed boards (Hike, Cramming, Coffee, Haunted) and two sponsored ones (Little Wins, Game Time)
Selected state	The chosen tile turns from grey to white and its lock changes to unlocked: two signals, not just color

4. Post confirm (UI states)

Goal: never leave the user wondering what happened.

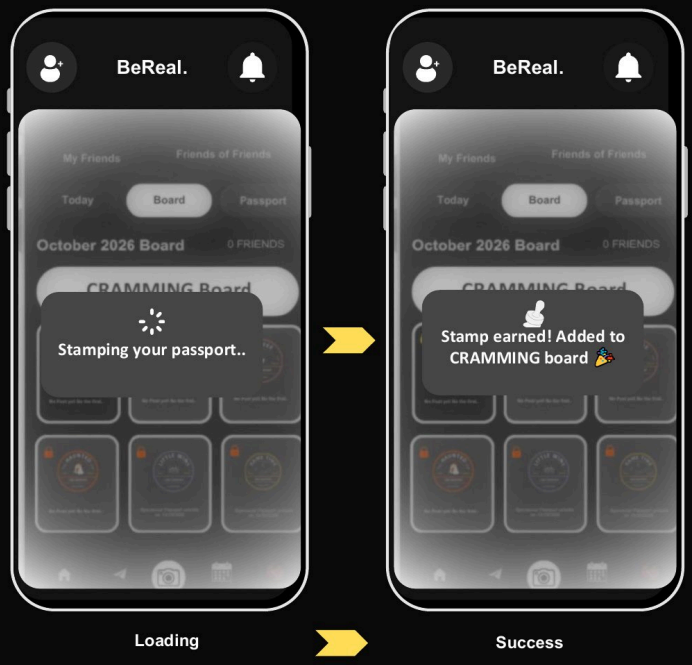
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Post Confirm

- Happy path messages:
  - Loading
    - *"Stamping your passport.."*
  - Success
    - *"Stamp earned! Added to CRAMMING board 🎉"*
- If something goes wrong, a message will display:
  - Empty state
    - *"No one's posted to this board yet - be the first!"*
  - Error state
    - *"⚠ That didn't go through. Let's try again."*



UI STATES COVERED

Designed for more than the happy path

What happens when things are empty, loading , or go wrong.

Empty

Board Selection / Capsule

"No one's posted to this board yet — be the first!"

Loading

Post Confirmation

"Stamping your passport…"

Success

Post Confirmation

"Stamp earned! Added to Coffee Shop 🎉"

Error

Post Confirmation

"That didn't go through — let's try again."

State	Message	Design decision
Loading	"Stamping your passport.."	A spinner in the modal; the copy turns waiting into anticipation
Success	"Stamp earned! Added to CRAMMING board 🎉"	The stamp image appears, a reward moment, with "See it on the board" and "Open my Passport" buttons

State	Message	Design decision
Error	"⚠️ That didn't go through. Let's try again."	Calm, blame-free copy; the photo is kept so nothing is lost
Empty	"No one's posted to this board yet — be the first!"	Turns a dead end into an invitation

5. Board feed

Goal: show the post landing among the squad's posts.



The user's post appears in the CRAMMING board feed with the **passport stamp in the corner** of the photo, the same placement as a real passport stamp. Friends' stamped posts sit below it. Reactions are emoji-based and visible only to the squad.

6. Today screen (returning user)

Goal: give returning users a reason to come back every day.

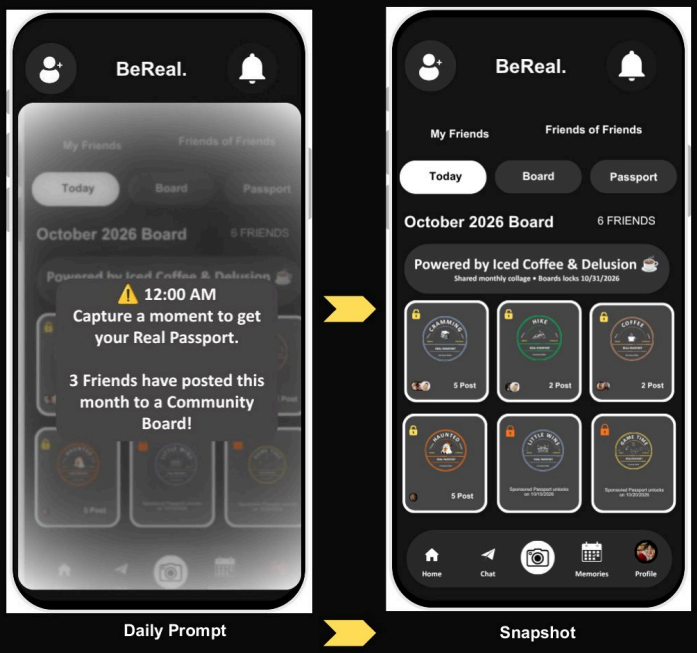
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

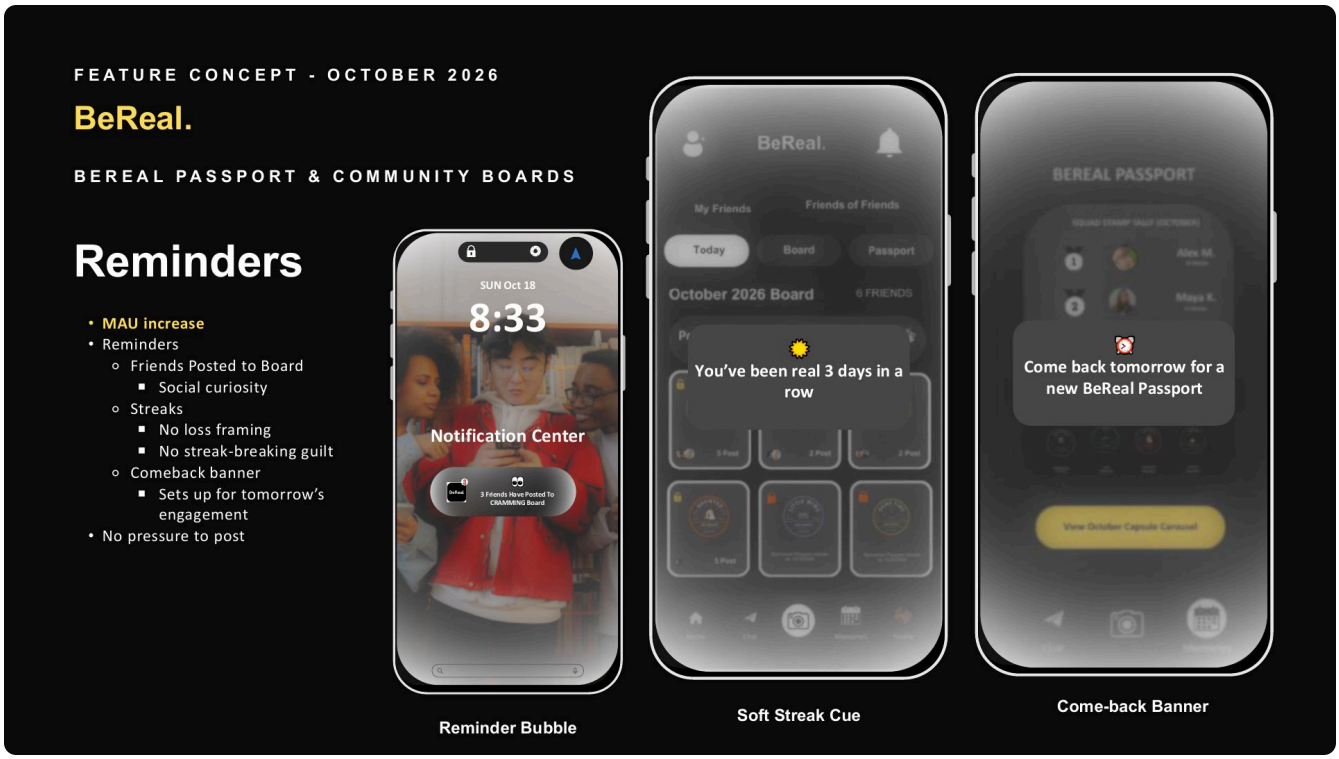
Today Screen *(Returning User)*

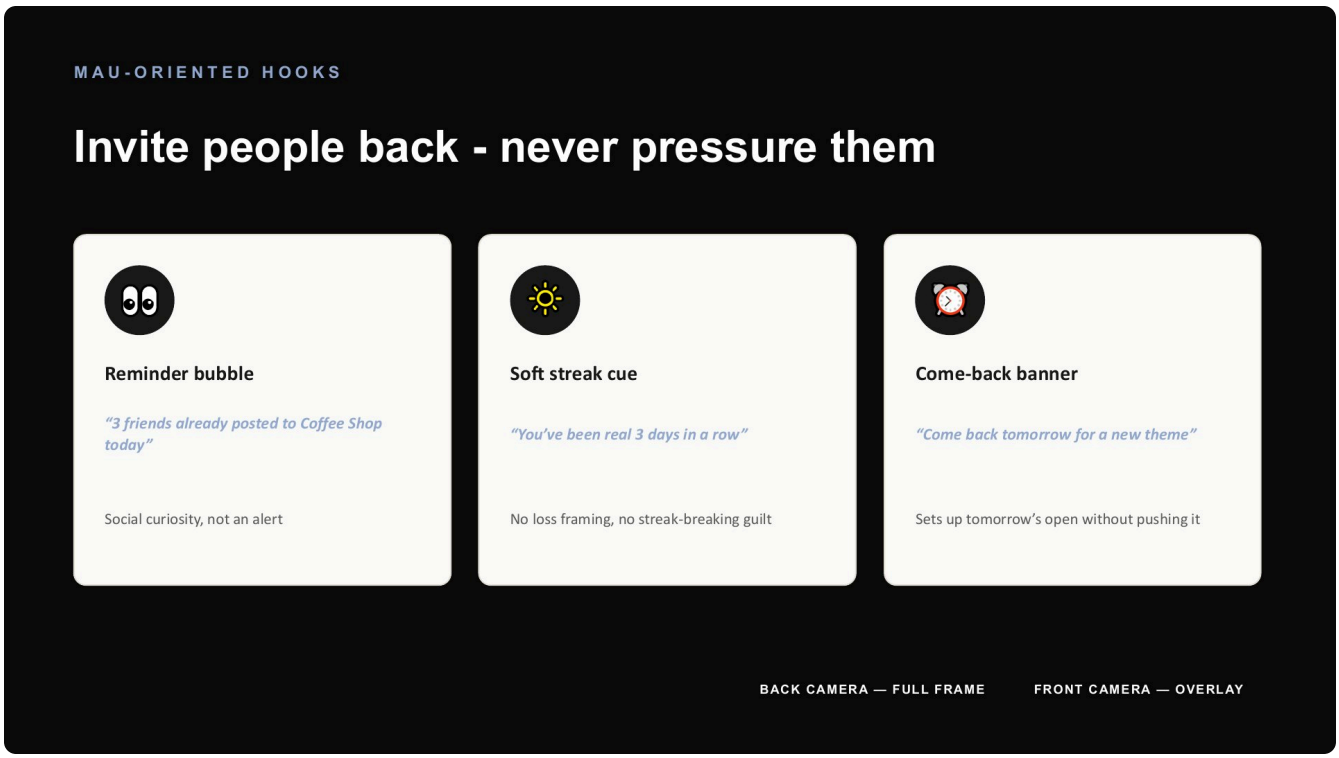
- **MAU increase**
- Daily Prompt
- Reminders
  - Friends Posted to Board
  - Streaks
  - Comeback banner
- Once user has opt-in to join 1 or more community boards, 'Today Screen' will show October snapshot.
- Snapshot view of all the community boards available for the month (themed & sponsored)
- Each community board snapshot shows:
  - State (locked or unlocked)
  - Image of Real Passport stamp
  - Friends who have posted
  - Number of Post



Element	Design decision
Daily prompt	A pop-up: "3 Friends have posted this month to a Community Board!" Social curiosity, not an alarm
Sponsor line	"Powered by Iced Coffee & Delusion ☕ · Board locks 10/31/2026", showing how sponsorship could appear without ads in the feed
Board snapshot	Every board at a glance: lock state, stamp, friends who've posted, number of posts

7. Reminders (re-engagement hooks)



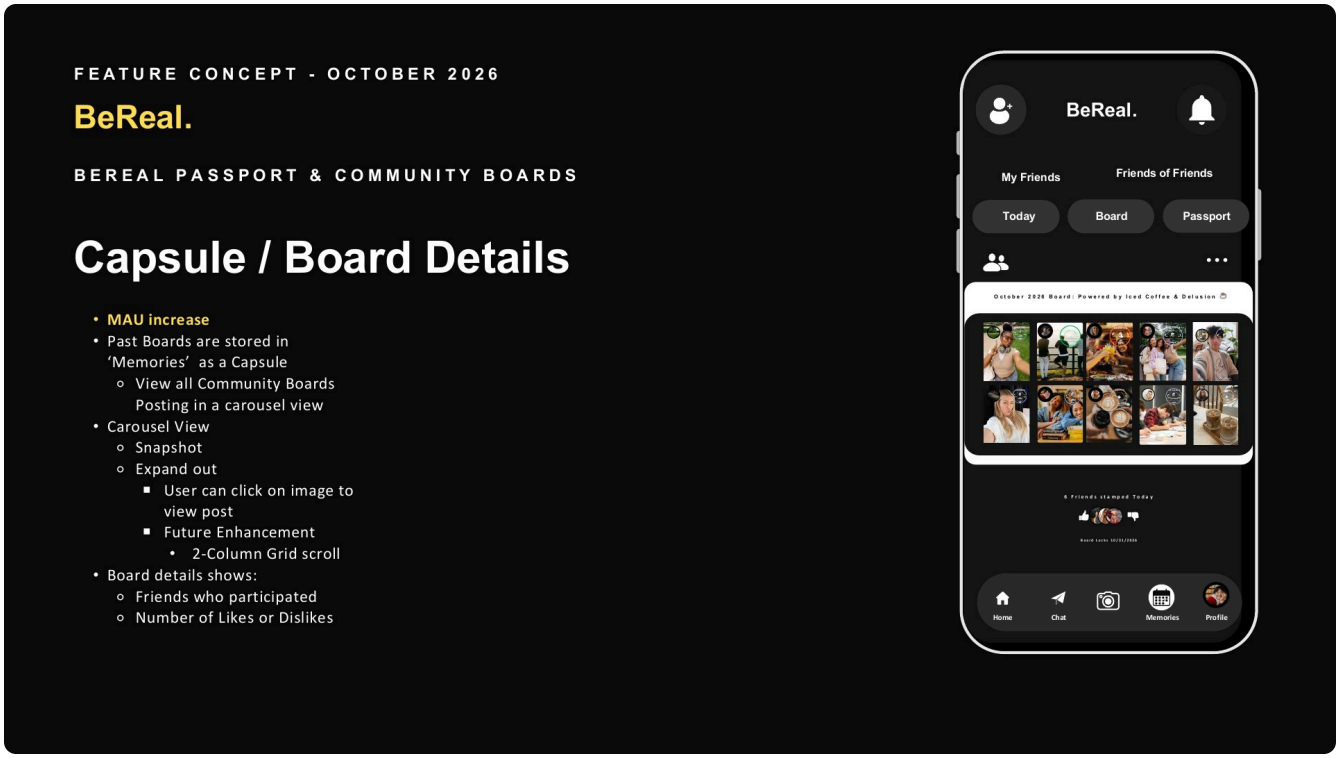


Hook	Copy	Design decision
Reminder bubble	"3 friends already posted to CRAMMING today 👀"	Lands in the notification center; curiosity, not an alert
Soft streak cue	"You've been real 3 days in a row ☀️"	No loss framing and no streak to break

Hook	Copy	Design decision
Come-back banner	"Come back tomorrow for a new BeReal Passport ⏰"	Sets up tomorrow's open without pushing it

8. Capsule / board details

Goal: turn each month into a keepsake.



Past boards live in **Memories** as a capsule: a collage of the month's posts that opens into a carousel. Board details show who took part and the 👍 / 👎 totals. A two-column grid scroll is noted on the slide as a future enhancement.

9. BeReal Passport

Goal: make collecting feel tactile and worth coming back for.



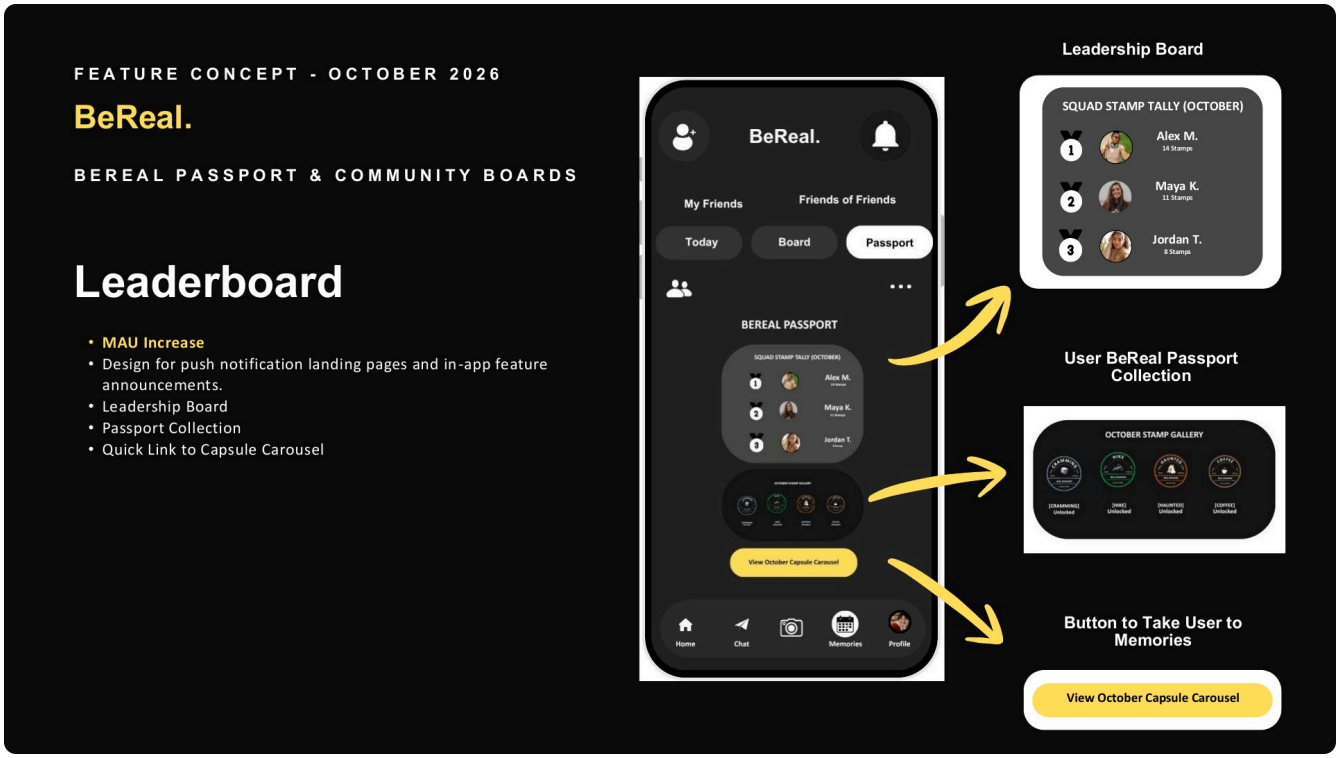
Six stamps designed as **vintage passport badges**. Each one shares the same structure (curved board name, illustration, "REAL PASSPORT", "BeReal." and "Unfiltered" labels and the month), and each has its own ink color and illustration:

Stamp	Illustration	Ink
Coffee	Steaming cup	Warm tan
Haunted	Ghost	Burnt orange
Cramming	Stack of books	Slate blue
Hike	Mountains	Green
Game Time	Sports balls	Gold
Little Wins	Celebrating friends	Soft blue

An "October 2026 Release" label signals that new designs arrive every month, including sponsored ones.

10. Leaderboard (Squad Stamp Tally)

Goal: add light, friendly competition inside the squad only.



The Passport tab stacks three parts: the **Squad Stamp Tally** (ranked avatars with medal numbers and stamp counts), the **October stamp gallery** (earned stamps marked "Unlocked"), and a yellow **"View October Capsule Carousel"** button, the screen's one accent-colored call to action.

11. Settings / opt-out

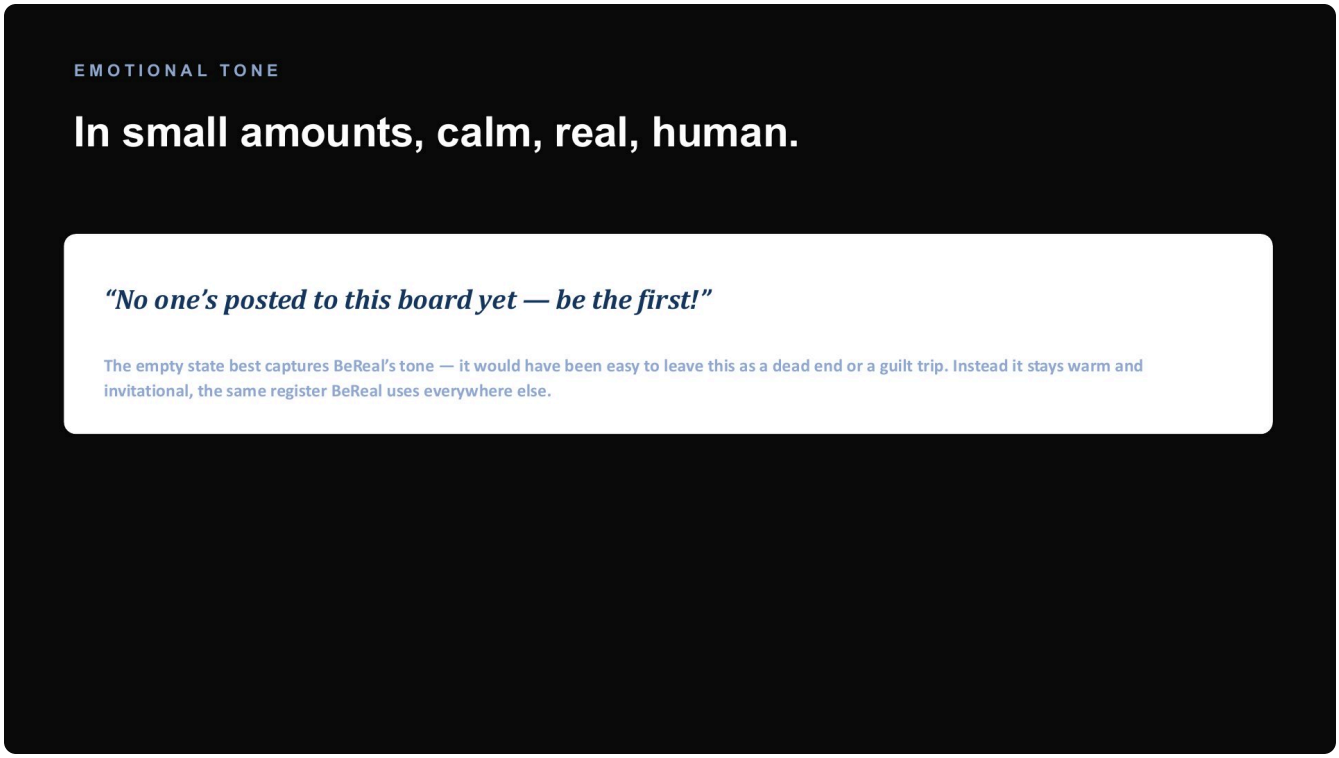
Goal: keep users in control at all times.



Element	Design decision
Features section	New rows, "Opt-in - Community Board" and "Opt-out - Community Board", sit with BeReal's existing settings rows, using the same row style
Board list	Each current board has its own stamp icon, name and ON / OFF switch
Helper text	"You can only opt-in or opt-out of current boards," which sets expectations up front

Staying true to the BeReal brand

BeReal brand trait	How the design keeps it
Authenticity	The photo is the same real, unfiltered dual-camera BeReal; the stamp is a layer on top, never a filter or edit
Minimal, dark interface	Same black canvas, white wordmark and sparse chrome; only stamps and one CTA per screen add color
"BeReal." wordmark	Kept on every screen, and printed on every stamp alongside "Unfiltered"
Familiar navigation	Top bar, Friends tabs and bottom navigation unchanged; the feature adds one row of tabs (Today · Board · Passport)
Reciprocity	The locked feed stays: post to see your friends' posts
Candid, playful voice	Copy like "Stamping your passport..", "be the first!" and "Powered by Iced Coffee & Delusion" matches BeReal's casual tone
No vanity metrics	No public likes or follower counts; reactions and the tally stay inside the squad
Low pressure	No countdown timers on boards, no streak loss and fully opt-in



What I deliberately didn't add: an algorithmic feed, public leaderboards, loss-framed streaks or filters. Each would have increased engagement on paper while breaking what makes BeReal *BeReal*. The reasoning is in the Feature Working Session.

From Canva to a clickable prototype

Step	What happened
1. Canva deck	Every screen, state and hook designed and annotated, slide by slide
2. Spec handoff	The deck became the specification for a clickable HTML prototype built with Claude, including the UI states and a demo panel for first-time vs. returning users (prompt engineering)
3. User testing	5 testers used the clickable prototype: 4 of 5 would open BeReal more often, and the main friction was the number of taps
4. Refinement	In the case study and PRD v2.0, the opt-in wording was corrected to "opt-in only" and the Settings icons were refined to standard back arrows and chevrons
5. Job aid	Real prototype screens captured into an interactive job aid

What I'd refine next

- **Fewer taps from shutter to stamp:** for example, remember the last board used, or show board chips right on the post-type screen.

- **Clearer SEND vs. COMMUNITY BOARD labels** with a one-line explainer on first use.
- **A first-use walkthrough** for new users, tested with non-users.